

Adobe is a company that has built its empire on the backs of creative professionals, only to trap them in a web of confusing pricing, aggressive enforcement, and one-sided legal terms. My investigation reveals a consistent pattern of user-hostile practices designed to maximize revenue at the expense of fairness, transparency, and user rights. The pricing structure is intentionally chaotic. A Photography plan is cheaper than Lightroom alone. Substance 3D Texturing is cheaper than the Substance 3D Collection. The naming conventions are inconsistent and overwhelming. Users can't make informed choices. They are forced to navigate a maze of plans, bundles, and add-ons, each designed to extract the maximum amount of money from different user segments. This isn't complexity. This is deception. The subscription terms are even worse. Automatic renewal without notice. A 50% early termination fee for annual plans. No refund after 14 days. These aren't customer-friendly policies. They are financial traps designed to lock users in and penalize them for leaving. The message is clear: pay, stay, and don't complain. The Privacy Policy and General Terms of Use are written entirely in Adobe's favor. They grant Adobe a broad license to user content. They allow Adobe to analyze user data for "Content Analytics" without explicit consent. They limit Adobe's liability to \$100 or three months of fees. They force users into mandatory arbitration. They strip users of their right to sue or join a class-action lawsuit. This isn't a fair agreement. This is a shield against accountability. The enforcement is aggressive and inconsistent. Adobe's Genuine Service (AGS) scans and locks out accounts, including legitimate users. Yet when I downloaded an older version of Photoshop from a Vietnamese website, I was completely unaffected. The scanning only targets the latest versions. It isn't about fighting piracy. It is about forcing upgrades and punishing users who don't comply. Users are left abandoned. Adobe doesn't provide official archives of older versions. Users who need them for compatibility are forced to download from third-party websites, risking security and malware. Adobe ignores them. Adobe doesn't care. Adobe is underestimating the law and the mass of lawsuits that will eventually come. The evidence is documented. The pattern is clear. Adobe is a company that prioritizes profit over people, control over fairness, and punishment over support.